

The Crafty NP — Store Owner's Guide

Everything you do day to day happens in one place: the **admin dashboard**. This guide walks through each job start to finish, and the last section is a troubleshooting list for when something doesn't behave.

Where	Address
Admin dashboard	https://api.thecraftynp.com/app
Your live store	https://thecraftynp.org

Signing in. Click *Continue with Google* and use your Crafty NP Google Workspace account. There is no password to remember — the Google account is the login. Only accounts on the business domain can get in, and each person needs to be set up once by your developer before their first sign-in.

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1. Products

Products → Create.

The fields that matter

Field	Why it matters
Title	The name shoppers see, and what search engines index.
Handle	The web address. <code>beach-tumbler</code> becomes <code>thecraftynp.org/drinkware/beach-tumbler</code> .
Description	Shown on the product page. Write it for the shopper, not for a spec sheet.
Media / Thumbnail	The thumbnail is the picture on listing pages. Media is the gallery on the product page.
Weight, Length, Width, Height	Required. These are what price your shipping labels.
Category	Decides where the product lives on the site — see Categories .

Sales channel	Must include the Default Sales Channel or the product will not appear on the site.
Status	<i>Draft</i> is invisible to shoppers. <i>Published</i> is live.

Weight and size are required to publish

Enter **weight in grams** and **length, width and height in centimetres**. If you try to publish a product without all four, the save is refused with a message naming exactly what's missing, for example:

Cannot publish "Beach Tumbler": weight (grams) and length, width (cm) are required.

This is deliberate. Shipping labels are priced from the real parcel, and there is no flat-rate fallback — a product with no size would block the order at the point of buying a label instead of at the point of adding the product.

Give the **packed** measurements, box included, not the bare item. Round up.

Variants and options

If a product comes in several versions — sizes, colours, scents — add an **option** (e.g. "Size") with its values ("Small", "Medium", "Large"), then let the dashboard generate a **variant** for each combination. Each variant carries its own **price, SKU and stock**.

- Prices are entered in **US dollars**. The store sells in USD only.
- On the storefront, a shopper picks the option values and the matching variant's price and stock appear. Combinations you never created, or that are sold out, are shown as unavailable.
- If a product has no variations at all, leave it with the single default variant and just set its price.

A good publishing checklist

1. Title, description, handle.
2. Thumbnail plus at least two gallery images.
3. Weight and the three dimensions, packed.
4. Prices on every variant.
5. Category assigned.
6. Default Sales Channel ticked.
7. Stock set (see [Inventory](#)).
8. Status → Published.

Then open the product on the live site and check it reads the way you meant.

2. Categories

Products → Categories.

Categories do three jobs on this store:

1. **They are the top navigation.** Every *top-level* category appears in the header menu, in alphabetical order.

2. **They are the homepage carousel.** One slide per top-level category, with the photo you give it.
3. **They are the web address.** A category with the handle `drinkware` lives at `thecraftynp.org/drinkware`, and its products at `thecraftynp.org/drinkware/beach-tumbler`.

Creating one

Give it a **name** (what shoppers read) and a **handle** (what appears in the address — lowercase, hyphens, no spaces). Set it **Active** and **Public** so it shows up.

Handles you cannot use. These are already used by pages on the site, and a category using one will not work: `products`, `about`, `account`, `auth`, `checkout`, `design`, `sign-in`. Pick anything else.

The category photo

Open a category and look for the **Image** panel on the right.

- **Upload** a photo — this is the background of that category's slide in the homepage carousel. Without one, the slide falls back to a plain pattern.
- **Alt text** describes the photo for shoppers using a screen reader. Leave it blank only if the photo is purely decorative.
- Click **Save** in that panel. It saves separately from the rest of the category.

Subcategories

You can nest a category under a parent. Nested categories do **not** appear in the header or the homepage carousel — only top-level ones do. Use nesting for organising a large catalogue, not for promoting a range.

Renaming and deleting

Changing a handle changes the web address, and any old link — a customer's bookmark, a social post, a Google result — will break. Rename the *name* freely; change the *handle* only when you have a reason.

3. Inventory

Stock lives on the **variant**, not the product. Open a product, then a variant, and you'll find the inventory settings.

The three settings

- **Manage inventory** — off means "always available, never counts down". Right for made-to-order pieces. On means the store tracks a number.
- **Quantity** — how many you have. Every completed order reduces it.
- **Allow backorder** — on means shoppers can still buy at zero stock. Off means the variant sells out.

What shoppers see

Stock	On the product page	Can they buy?
More than 5	<i>In stock</i>	Yes

1 to 5	<i>Low stock — order soon</i>	Yes
0	<i>Out of stock</i>	No
Manage inventory off, or backorder on	<i>In stock</i>	Yes

Out-of-stock products still appear in listings — the Add to cart button is simply disabled. To take something off the site entirely, set its status back to **Draft**.

Restocking

Edit the variant's quantity to the new total, not the amount you added. If you had 2 and made 10 more, enter 12.

A note on reservations

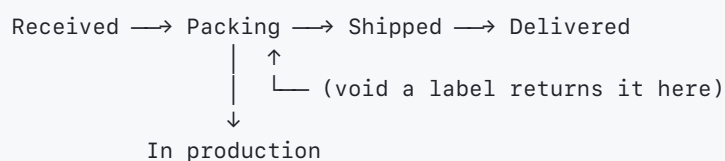
When you buy a shipping label, the stock for that order is consumed. If you then void the label, the stock is put back and the order returns to *Packing*. You don't need to adjust anything by hand for a void.

4. Orders and fulfilment

There are two places to work with orders:

- **Orders** — the full list. Open any order for the customer, items, totals, payment, and the **Fulfilment** panel on the right.
- **Fulfilment** — a dedicated workspace listing only the orders that are packed and waiting for a label, plus every label you've bought recently.

The order lifecycle



Any of *Received*, *Packing* or *In production* can also be **Cancelled**. *Delivered* and *Cancelled* are final — nothing moves out of them.

- **Received** — paid, nothing done yet. This is where every new order lands.
- **Packing** — you're making or boxing it. **An order only appears in the Fulfilment workspace once you move it to Packing.**
- **In production** — for longer custom work, when you want to distinguish "being made" from "being boxed". Optional.
- **Shipped** — set automatically when you buy a label. You never set this by hand.
- **Delivered** — set automatically when the carrier reports delivery. You can also set it yourself.

Move an order along with the buttons in the **Fulfilment** panel on the order page. Every change is recorded in the History list underneath, with a timestamp.

Shipping an order, start to finish

1. **Orders** → open the order → **Mark packing**.
2. Go to **Fulfilment** in the left menu. The order is now in the queue.
3. Click its row. You'll see the delivery address, a **packing list** of what goes in the box, and the parcel panel.
4. **Check the parcel**. Weight in grams, size in centimetres. It's calculated from the products in the order — correct it if the real box differs. *Reset to calculated* puts the numbers back.
5. **Get live rates**. Real prices come back from the carriers, with delivery estimates.
6. Pick a rate and click **Buy label**. You'll be asked to confirm, and told the exact amount.
7. **Print the label**. Use **4 × 6 in, Actual size (100%), Margins: None** — any other setting and the barcode may not scan.

Buying the label does three things at once: charges your ShipStation balance, moves the order to **Shipped**, and emails the customer their tracking number.

Rates go stale

Quotes older than **15 minutes** are refused, with a warning to refresh. Carriers reprice constantly, and the final charge is set at the moment of purchase — it can differ from the quote by a few cents. That's normal.

Printing several labels at once

The Fulfilment page lists **Labels ready to print** — everything bought in the last two weeks. Tick as many as you like and print them as a single job. Same print settings: 4 × 6, 100%, no margins.

Voiding a label

On the order's Fulfilment panel, **Void label**. Read this before you use it:

- It asks the carrier to cancel the label. **The carrier does not always agree**, and does not always refund. If they refuse, you'll be told, and the order still returns to Packing so you can try again.
- It hides the tracking link from the customer and puts the stock back.
- **It does not un-send the shipped email**. If tracking has already gone out, message the customer yourself.

If buying a label fails

You'll get a plain-English message saying what happened and what to do. The common ones:

Message	What to do
Not enough funds	Top up your ShipStation balance, then buy again.
The carrier rejected it	Usually a bad address or an impossible parcel. Check both.
Timed out	Do not immediately buy again . Refresh the order first — the label may have gone through. Buying twice charges twice.
No carrier would quote	The weight or size is wrong. Fix the parcel and re-rate.

Cancelling an order

Use **Mark cancelled** on an order that hasn't shipped. Refunding the customer is separate — issue that from the order's payment section, or in Stripe.

5. Promotions and sale pricing

Read this first. The checkout has **no promo-code box**. A discount code created under *Promotions* cannot be typed in by a shopper today, because there is nowhere on the site to type it. Adding one is a development change — ask your developer if you want it.

The discount mechanism that is wired up end to end is a **sale price**, and it's described below.

Running a sale (this works today)

Pricing → Price lists → Create, type Sale.

1. Give it a name and, optionally, a start and end date. Dates are the easiest way to run a weekend sale without having to remember to switch it off.
2. Choose the products or variants it covers.
3. Set the sale price for each.
4. Save.

On the site, every product in the list immediately shows:

- a **Sale** badge on its card in listings,
- the old price **struck through** beside the new one,
- a **"Save 25%"** style label on the product page.

To end a sale early, deactivate or delete the price list. The old price comes straight back.

Just changing a price

For a permanent change, edit the variant's price directly. No price list, no strike-through, no Sale badge — it simply becomes the new price.

Free shipping and other promotions

The *Promotions* section of the dashboard exists, but as noted above, shoppers have no way to enter a code, so a code-based promotion will never be redeemed. If you want free shipping over a threshold, or a percentage off sitewide, talk to your developer about how to wire it into checkout rather than creating a promotion and assuming it applies.

6. Site content

Site content in the left menu. This is where you edit the words and photos on the site itself — no developer needed.

Everything on this page follows the same rules:

- **Photos upload the moment you choose them**, but they don't appear on the site until you press **Save**.
- Images are automatically resized down and must be under **5 MB**.
- **Clear** on an image field removes it. Where a field says "leave empty to hide this tile", clearing it removes that piece from the page entirely.
- Character limits are enforced as you type — the field simply stops accepting more.
- **Alt text** describes a photo aloud for shoppers using a screen reader. Write what's in the picture. Leave it blank only when the photo adds nothing the surrounding text doesn't already say.

What's on the page

Announcement bar — the strip above the header.

- *Show the announcement bar* — the on/off switch.
- *Announcement text* — one line, up to 200 characters. Good for "Free shipping this weekend" or "Orders placed after the 18th ship in January".

Fresh from the workshop — the homepage gallery.

- A heading and a one-line intro.
- Four tiles, each with a **square** photo and a caption. The caption doubles as the photo's alt text. **Leave a tile's image empty and that tile disappears** — so you can run two or three instead of four.

About the maker — the homepage introduction block.

- Eyebrow (the small uppercase label), heading, one paragraph of body copy, a **portrait** photo — portrait orientation works best — its alt text, and the label on the link through to the About page.

About page — the full `/about` page.

- Hero: eyebrow, heading, body paragraph, portrait photo and alt text, and the button label that sends people to the shop.
- Story: a heading and the longer story. **Separate paragraphs with a blank line.**
- Closing band: heading, one line of body copy, and the button label.

Order confirmation — two lines shown on the thank-you page *and inside the confirmation email*.

- *Production turnaround* — how long you take to make an order.
- *Shipping window* — how long delivery takes once it's gone.

Keep these honest and current. They set the expectation that decides whether a customer emails you asking where their order is.

Saving

Press **Save** and the site updates. If you navigate away without saving, your edits are lost.

7. What emails your customers get

Three automatic emails, all branded:

When	Email
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The order is paid	Order confirmation — items, totals, and your turnaround and shipping lines from Site content.
You buy a shipping label	Shipped — the tracking number and a link.
A customer asks to reset a password	Password reset.

You do not send these by hand, and there is no “resend” button. If a customer says an email never arrived, ask them to check spam, and forward the details yourself if needed.

8. Troubleshooting

“It won’t let me publish a product.” Weight and all three dimensions are required, and the message names which are missing. Fill them in, then publish.

“My product isn’t on the site.” In order of likelihood: its status is Draft; it isn’t in the Default Sales Channel; it has no category; it has no price. Check all four.

“My category isn’t in the menu.” Only top-level categories appear — check it doesn’t have a parent. It must also be Active and Public. And if its handle is one of the reserved words (`products` , `about` , `account` , `auth` , `checkout` , `design` , `sign-in`), it will not work; change it.

“The homepage carousel slide has no photo.” Open the category and upload one in the **Image** panel on the right, then press **Save** in that panel specifically.

“The order isn’t in the Fulfilment queue.” It’s still *Received*. Open it and **Mark packing**.

“It says the parcel needs a weight.” One or more products in the order has no saved size. Type the parcel in by hand to get the label out today — then go and fix the product, so it’s calculated automatically next time.

“The rates are greyed out / it won’t let me buy.” The quote is more than 15 minutes old. Click **Refresh rates**.

“Buying the label timed out and I don’t know if it worked.” Refresh the order page and look at its Fulfilment panel. If tracking is there, the label was bought — do not buy another. If not, buy again.

“The customer says their tracking link is dead.” If you voided the label, that’s expected — the link is removed on purpose. Buy a new label; a fresh tracking number goes out with it.

“I edited site content and nothing changed.” You uploaded but didn’t **Save**, or you’re looking at a cached page — hard refresh with Ctrl+Shift+R (Cmd+Shift+R on a Mac).

“A discount code isn’t working.” There is no promo-code box at checkout. Use a **Sale price list** instead — see [section 5](#).

“I can’t sign in to the dashboard.” Sign-in is Google Workspace only, on the business domain — a personal Gmail account will always be refused. If the right account is refused, it hasn’t been set up in the dashboard yet. Contact your developer.

9. When to call your developer

Some things aren't editable from the dashboard by design. These need a code change or an account with a third party:

- Page layout, colours, fonts, and any wording not on the **Site content** page.
- Adding a promo-code box to checkout, or free-shipping rules.
- New pages, new form fields, changes to how checkout works.
- Shipping carriers and services, or the address parcels ship from.
- Sales tax registrations and rates.
- The wording of the automatic emails.
- Adding another person to the dashboard.
- Anything that involves a refund you can't complete in the dashboard or Stripe.